

# Chapter 9

## Invest In Your Career

*“I can not do everything, but I can do something. I must not fail to do the something that I can do.” –Helen Keller*

A low income can be a stumbling block for many looking to *Choose FI*. It's important to control spending, but there is a floor on how low spending can go. You can't squeeze blood from a stone. Let's review the savings rate equation:

$$\text{Savings Rate} = \text{Savings} / \text{Earnings}$$

Savings is simply the amount you earn minus the amount you spend or:

$$\text{Savings} = \text{Earnings} - \text{Spending}$$

The savings rate equation, stated a different way looks like this:

$$\text{Savings Rate} = (\text{Earnings} - \text{Spending}) / \text{Earnings}$$

Frugality can allow you to create margin quickly. Living on less has leverageable benefits, such as paying less tax and needing less insurance. Still, spending can only go so low before bottoming out.